

WINGS DOWN Qatar Airways passenger jets at the JFK Airport in New York, Mar. 2

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VIEW FROM **QATAR**

Forging A Lasting Peace

The Gulf states, those most exposed to the economic and security fallout of a conflict not of their making, must be integral to any negotiated settlement for regional stability and sustainable peace



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Tensions between the US, Israel and Iran can be traced to the aftermath of Iran's 1979 Islamic Revolution, marking the beginning of a prolonged and evolving confrontation. Over time, this rivalry has largely unfolded through proxy conflicts and strategic positioning, gradually emerging as a central force shaping the geopolitical dynamics of the Middle East. What initially appeared as a contained dispute has expanded into a complex struggle with significant implications for regional stability and the broader international order.

One of the most consequential outcomes of this protracted conflict has been the gradual erosion of international law and the weakening of the global system established in the aftermath of the Second World War. Confidence in multilateral institutions and the frameworks governing state behaviours has steadily diminished. Across multiple conflict zones, including Gaza, Ukraine, Lebanon, Syria, Sudan and Iran, there has been a discernible shift toward the use of military force as a primary tool of dispute resolution, often at the expense of diplomacy.

The growing normalisation of attacks on civilian infrastructure, including schools and hospitals, alongside acts of genocide and violations of states' sovereignty, poses a cata-